

The Battle of Marawi: Small Team Lessons Learned for the Close Fight

By James Lewis

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The Battle of Marawi started in May 2017 when Islamist militants took control of Marawi City in the southern Philippines. This resulted in a five-month battle between the Armed Forces of the Philippines (AFP) and the Islamist militants. The conflict caused severe damage to the city, forced thousands of people to leave their homes, and resulted in many deaths and injuries. In his article, James Lewis explains how this battle became an important learning experience for military forces, especially in urban warfare.

Lewis points out that the AFP was more experienced in fighting in jungles than in cities. Because of this, the soldiers had to quickly adjust to the difficult conditions of fighting in an urban environment. He explains that although military equipment and technology were important, the battle was won because of the courage, teamwork, and determination of the soldiers on the ground.

The article also discusses the lessons learned from the battle. Lewis highlights the importance of proper training, strong leadership, clear communication, and coordination between different military units. He also explains how equipment such as armored vehicles, drones, and medical support helped the soldiers during the operation. Most importantly, he emphasizes that being flexible, creative, and able to adapt to unexpected situations played a major role in achieving success.

The Battle of Marawi showed that winning a modern conflict requires more than advanced weapons. It also depends on disciplined soldiers, effective teamwork, strong leadership, and careful planning. Lewis concludes that the lessons learned from Marawi can help military organizations better prepare for future urban conflicts while improving their ability to protect both soldiers and civilians.



Reference:

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<https://cove.army.gov.au/article/battle-marawi-small-team-lessons-learned-close-fight>